

THE HYROX PACING GUIDE

The race is won on the compromised runs.

Most age-groupers lose HYROX in the same place: the first two runs. They go out hard while fresh, spike their heart rate on the sleds, and then bleed 30–60 seconds a kilometre on every run after — the "compromised" runs you do with fatigued legs and a taxed engine. This guide shows you how to pace so those runs hold. Read it once before race week, then again the night before.

The format, at a glance

Eight 1 km runs, each followed by one station, in a fixed order. Loads below are the official 25/26 Singles standards.

#	STATION	WORK	WOMEN	MEN (OPEN)	PRO W / PRO M
1	SkiErg	1,000 m	Same all divisions		
2	Sled Push	50 m	102 kg	152 kg	152 / 202 kg
3	Sled Pull	50 m	78 kg	103 kg	103 / 153 kg
4	Burpee Broad Jump	80 m	Same all divisions		
5	Row	1,000 m	Same all divisions		
6	Farmers Carry	200 m	2×16 kg	2×24 kg	2×24 / 2×32 kg
7	Sandbag Lunges	100 m	10 kg	20 kg	20 / 30 kg
8	Wall Balls	100 reps	4 kg → 2.70 m	6 kg → 3.00 m	6 kg / 9 kg → 3.00 m

Sled weights are total, including the sled. "Roxzone" = the transition running between the track and each station; it counts toward your time.

THE ONE PRINCIPLE THAT MATTERS MOST

Run the first two 1 km runs at a pace that feels almost too easy. If Run 1 feels "good and strong," it's too fast. The goal is to arrive at the SkiErg with your heart rate controlled, and to still be running — not shuffling — on Runs 6, 7, and 8. You cannot win HYROX in the first 2 km, but you can absolutely lose it there.

Build your pacing plan from your goal time

Work backwards. Your finish time is roughly your total running time plus your total station-and-transition time. Estimate the station side, and whatever's left is your running budget — divided by eight.

GOAL FINISH	EST. STATION + ROXZONE*	LEFT FOR 8 RUNS	AVG RUN / KM	RUNS 1–2 (HOLD BACK)	RUNS 5–8 (EXPECT)
1:00:00	~25 min	~35 min	4:22	4:10–4:15	4:35–4:55
1:10:00	~28 min	~42 min	5:15	5:00–5:05	5:30–5:55
1:20:00	~31 min	~49 min	6:07	5:50–5:55	6:25–6:50
1:30:00	~34 min	~56 min	7:00	6:40–6:45	7:20–7:50
1:40:00	~37 min	~63 min	7:52	7:25–7:35	8:15–8:45

*Station + roxzone time varies with strength — sleds and wall balls dominate it. Treat this as a starting frame and calibrate against a time-trial. The runs 1–2 / runs 5–8 columns are the real race plan: bank margin early, then pace so the fade is 20–40s/km — not 90.

Station-by-station strategy

1 • SkiErg

You arrive with fresh arms — resist the urge to hammer. Settle into a rhythm you could hold for 3 km. Full range, drive from the hips, don't just yank with the arms.

2 • Sled Push

The biggest heart-rate spike of the day. Low body angle, short powerful steps, drive through the whole foot. Plan your breaks *before* you start (e.g. two brief resets) rather than stopping when you blow up.

3 • Sled Pull

Find a rhythm: pull hand-over-hand, sit your bodyweight back, walk the rope back fast between pulls. Efficiency here saves your grip for the farmers carry.

4 • Burpee Broad Jump

This is a recovery station in disguise. Go slow and unbroken, control your breathing, step (don't jump) back up. Consistency beats speed — nobody wins on the burpees, but people blow up on them.

5 • Row

Steady, not a sprint. Aim for a split ~5–8s slower than your fresh 1 km row pace. Relax the upper body; this is a chance to bring the HR down before the back half.

6 • Farmers Carry

Grip is the limiter. Go unbroken if you can — putting the bells down costs more time than it saves. Fast feet, tall posture, breathe.

7 • Sandbag Lunges

Slow and unbroken. Resting with the bag racked still fatigues you, so keep moving at a sustainable cadence. Full depth — a no-rep here is brutal to redo.

8 • Wall Balls

Break them *before* you fail, from rep one. Sets of 10–25 with 2–3 breaths between beats going unbroken-to-failure. Consistent rhythm, hit depth and height every rep — no-reps at the end are soul-crushing.

The five most common mistakes

- **Going out too hard on Runs 1–2.** The single biggest one. See page 1.
- **Redlining the first sled.** Spiking your HR to the roof on the sled push wrecks the next three stations. Controlled aggression, planned breaks.
- **Resting *in* the roxzone.** The transition running counts. Keep moving — walking with purpose beats standing still.
- **Going unbroken on wall balls until you fail.** One big failure set costs far more than planned small breaks.
- **No plan for the compromised runs.** Expect them to be 20–40s/km slower and pace them *on purpose* instead of panicking.

Race-week checklist

T-3 DAYS Last hard session done; now it's sharpening, not fitness.

T-1 DAY Re-read this guide. Write your run splits on your hand or forearm.

MORNING Eat what you've trained on. Arrive early, know your heat time.

WARM-UP Easy jog + a few strides + light SkiErg. Prime, don't tire.

FIRST 2 KM Discipline. Let people pass you. You'll catch them at Run 6.

BACK HALF This is where your training shows. Hold the runs.

Splits are the *what*. Training is the *how*.

Knowing how to pace is step one. Hitting these splits under fatigue takes a block built for it — easy days truly easy, hard days that rehearse the compromised runs, volume that ramps without breaking you. Duravel builds that block around your numbers and adapts it every week from what you actually log.

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